WEAPONS

Movie Recap Script | 15-Minute Cut

Runtime: 15:00 | About 2,280 words of narration | Full spoilers

HOW TO READ THIS SCRIPT

Red text: the timestamp where each section starts and ends.

Grey box: what to show on screen (B-roll and visual cues). Do not read it aloud.

Plain text: the narration. Read every word of it.

Orange box: an engagement prompt. Read it aloud. It asks viewers to comment, like or subscribe.

Title ideas:

- 17 Kids Vanished at 2:17 AM... Only ONE Came to School
- The Witch Was in the Basement the Whole Time | WEAPONS Recap
- This Boy Fed 17 Kidnapped Classmates Soup Every Day

0:00 - 0:41

COLD OPEN: 2:17 AM

> *ON SCREEN: Black screen. Clock ticking. Cut to a dark suburban street, then a child's bedroom door opening on its own. Slow push-in on an empty classroom: 18 desks, 17 empty chairs.*

At exactly 2:17 in the morning, seventeen children got out of bed.

They didn't scream. They didn't pack a bag. They opened their front doors, stretched their arms out wide like little airplanes, and ran straight into the dark. Doorbell cameras caught every single one of them. And then... nothing. Gone.

Seventeen kids. All from the same third-grade class. And the next morning, only one student walks into that classroom. One boy. Sitting quietly at his desk like nothing happened.

His name is Alex Lilly. And by the end of this video, you are going to wish you never looked into his house.

0:41 - 1:28

THE HOOK + SETUP

> *ON SCREEN: Title card: WEAPONS. Quick montage of the main faces: Justine, Archer, Paul, James, Marcus, Gladys.*

This is Weapons. And here's the thing that makes it different from every horror movie you've seen this year: the story is told through six different people. Six pieces of the same puzzle. Every time you think you understand what's going on, the movie swings the camera around and shows you what was happening behind your back.

So I'm not going to just walk you through it scene by scene. I'm going to show you the moments that actually matter, the clues most people missed the first time, and that ending that had the whole theater groaning.

> **ENGAGEMENT PROMPT: Before we start: drop the time you're watching this in the comments. If it says 2:17... I'm sorry. Lock your doors.**

1:28 - 3:49

CHAPTER 1: JUSTINE - THE TEACHER EVERYONE BLAMED

> *ON SCREEN: Justine alone in the empty classroom. Cut to the packed school gym, parents shouting. Spray paint on her car: WITCH.*

Justine Gandy is the teacher. Seventeen of her eighteen students are gone, and the town needs someone to hate. So they pick her.

At the parents' meeting, it gets ugly fast. Fathers yelling. Mothers crying. Fingers pointed straight at her, like she personally walked those kids out into the night. And the school principal, Marcus, doesn't defend her. He sends her home. Then he takes her off the job completely.

And this is where the movie plants its first poison seed: rumors. Whispers about Justine's past. About her getting too close to students. About her drinking. Nobody can prove a single thing, but in a town this scared, nobody needs proof. Her car gets vandalized. The word WITCH gets sprayed across it. Remember that word. It's going to come back in the worst way.

Then there's the clue that haunts the whole film: 2:17. It's the exact minute the kids ran. And the movie keeps sneaking that number back in. On a clock. On a screen. In the background of a shot. Like the town itself is stuck in that minute and can't get out.

Justine tries to keep it together. She really does. But one night, she walks into a liquor store, and there's Donna, one of the missing kids' mothers. Donna doesn't just glare at her. She corners her. Screams at her in front of everyone. And you can see it on Justine's face: something cracks.

So she relapses. Bottle in the car. And who shows up? Officer Paul. Her ex. A married cop who she absolutely should not be calling. They hook up again, and it's messy, and it's sad, and it's very human.

But Justine isn't just falling apart. She's watching. And when she drives past Alex's house, the one kid who didn't vanish, she notices something nobody else has. Every single window is covered. Taped over. From the inside.

Ask yourself: what kind of family tapes newspaper over every window... the week seventeen children disappear?

> **ENGAGEMENT PROMPT: Pause right here. Who did YOU suspect at this point in the movie? Justine, the parents, or Alex? Tell me in the comments. I read them all.**

3:49 - 5:10

CHAPTER 2: ARCHER - THE FATHER WHO WOULDN'T STOP

> *ON SCREEN: Archer lying awake in a child's bed with a small blanket. Cut to a wall map covered in red string and doorbell-cam stills.*

Now the camera swings to Archer Graff. His son Matthew is one of the seventeen. And the movie shows you his grief in the most quiet, gut-punching way possible.

Archer can't sleep. So he goes into Matthew's room and lies down in his son's tiny bed. His feet hang off the end. He just stares at the ceiling, night after night. No dialogue. You don't need any. If you're a parent, that scene stays with you.

But Archer isn't the type to cry and wait. He's the type to do the math. He goes door to door, house to house. He even visits Bailey's family, another missing kid, just to study the angle of their doorbell camera. He's collecting footage of every child running into the dark.

And then he does something genius. He takes the direction each kid ran, and he draws it out on a map. Line after line after line. Seventeen lines. And they all point to the same place.

Alex Lilly's street.

Here's what gets me: the police had the same footage. The same cameras. And nobody bothered to draw the lines. A grieving dad with a marker did what an entire department wouldn't. And we're about to find out exactly why.

5:10 - 6:52

CHAPTER 3: PAUL & JAMES - THE COP AND THE ADDICT

> *ON SCREEN: Paul in his patrol car. A camp in the woods littered with needles. A pawn shop counter. A basement door.*

Officer Paul is a mess. He's cheating on his wife with Justine, and when he arrests a homeless addict named James, things go wrong. Paul loses his temper, it gets violent, and his bodycam catches the whole thing. So what does he do? He covers it up. Buries the footage. Remember the police department not drawing those lines on the map? Yeah. The guy who's supposed to be protecting this town is busy protecting himself.

Now James. James lives in the woods, surrounded by needles, scraping by. He overdoses, survives, and keeps going. He's the guy this town looks right through. Which

makes him the perfect person to stumble into the truth.

Because someone's been planting little opportunities for him. Desperate for cash, James breaks into a house to steal something he can sell. And guess whose house it is. The Lillys. The taped-over windows.

He walks through that house in the dark, and it feels wrong. Too quiet. Then he finds the basement. And down there, standing perfectly still in the dark, facing nothing...

Are the missing children. All seventeen. Alive. Silent. Not moving. Not blinking.

James grabs what he can and runs. He tries to pawn it, but it turns out the pawn shop is a trap. And the next time we see James and Paul, they're not themselves anymore. Something got into their heads. Something turned them into tools. Into... weapons.

> **ENGAGEMENT PROMPT: If you just got chills, smash that like button. It honestly helps the channel more than you know, and there is so much more coming.**

6:52 - 8:37

CHAPTER 4: MARCUS - GLADYS COMES TO VISIT

> *ON SCREEN: A bright, cheerful knock at Marcus and Terry's door. Gladys in a garish orange wig and heavy makeup, smiling way too wide.*

And this is where we finally meet her. Aunt Gladys.

She shows up at the home of Principal Marcus and his husband Terry. Bright clothes. Loud makeup. A wig that looks like it was bought in a hurry. She's Alex's aunt, she says, staying with the family while his parents are sick. She's sweet. She's chatty. And something about her is so deeply off that you want to yell at the screen.

Because Marcus, like a good principal, wants to check on Alex. And Gladys does not want anyone checking on Alex.

She smiles. She does something small. A little ritual, a snip of something, a twist of something. And Marcus goes blank. His eyes empty out. And then this man, who loves his husband, turns around and attacks Terry. Brutally. He can't stop himself. That's the horror of Gladys: she doesn't need to touch you. She just needs a piece of you.

And that's when you realize why someone was snooping around Justine's car. Gladys has been collecting her hair. Justine is next on the list.

So Marcus, now completely controlled, is sent after her. Justine stops at a gas station, and Marcus comes sprinting out of nowhere, arms out, face twisted, moving like the kids

did on those doorbell cameras. It's one of the most terrifying chase scenes of the year. And it ends with Marcus dead.

Archer sees it. And in that moment, the father who blamed Justine for everything finally gets it. She's not the monster. She's being hunted by the monster. So the two most hated people in town team up.

8:37 - 10:53

CHAPTER 5: ALEX - THE BOY WHO STAYED

> *ON SCREEN: Alex at the kitchen table, alone. A spoon. A pot of soup. Two adults sitting perfectly frozen at the table.*

And now, finally, the movie shows us Alex's side. And I promise you, this is the saddest part of the entire film.

Gladys didn't come to help. Gladys is a witch. She's old, she's sick, and she's dying. She shows up at the Lilly house, and within minutes she has Alex's parents under her control. She takes their hair, she ties it up, and they just... stop. They sit at the table like statues.

And she tells Alex the rules. If he wants his mom and dad to live, he does what she says. Keep it secret. Keep going to school. And bring her things from his classmates. Something personal. Something with their name on it.

Alex is a kid. He's terrified. So he does it. He steals from his own friends. And at 2:17 that night, Gladys works her spell, and seventeen children run out of their homes and into Alex's basement.

Here's how the magic works, and it's honestly so creepy. Gladys takes a personal item, a hair, a name. She sets out bowls of water. She rings a little bell. And whoever's piece is in that bowl, they're hers. She drains their life to keep herself alive. Every day, she looks a little younger, a little stronger. Her skin tightens. Her hair comes back. She's literally feeding on these kids.

And Alex? Alex is the one who has to keep everyone alive. Every day, he comes home from school and spoons soup into his frozen parents' mouths. Then he goes down to the basement, and feeds seventeen of his classmates, one spoonful at a time.

An eight-year-old. Taking care of nineteen hostages. Alone. While the entire town is out searching for the kids that are sitting under his kitchen floor.

That's why he was the only one in class that morning. He wasn't lucky. He was a prisoner.

ENGAGEMENT PROMPT: Real question: if you were Alex, would you have told someone? Or would you have done exactly what he did to save your parents? Let me know below, because I genuinely can't decide.

10:53 - 13:10

CHAPTER 6: THE CLIMAX - THE HOUSE ON ALEX'S STREET

ON SCREEN: Archer and Justine outside the taped-up house at night. Hallway lights flicker. Paul and James in the doorway, eyes dead.

So, Archer and Justine head straight for the Lilly house. And Gladys is ready for them.

Waiting in the hallway are her new weapons: Paul and James. The cop and the addict. Brainwashed, sprinting, swinging. And what follows is one of the most brutal fights in the movie. Tight hallway, nowhere to run, bodies slamming into walls. Archer and Justine have to fight for their lives, and they end up killing both of them. There's no clean victory here. These were victims too.

And then Gladys plays her ace. She turns Archer.

The father who spent the whole movie trying to find his son is now coming at Justine with the same dead eyes as everyone else. Justine is fighting the only person who believed her, and she can't win without hurting him.

But here's what Gladys forgot about. The kid.

Alex has been watching. Studying. Every bowl of water, every bell, every ritual. And he realizes: if her magic works for her... maybe it works for him too.

Gladys sends his own parents after him. And the movie draws a line, literally. Alex has laid a line of salt, and he's standing behind it while his mother and father, under her control, stab and hurt themselves trying to break him. It is horrifying to watch. A little boy holding his ground while the people he loves tear themselves apart in front of him.

And then Alex crosses the line.

He does the spell himself. But he doesn't aim it at his parents. He aims seventeen children at Gladys.

The basement door flies open. The kids pour out, arms spread wide, the exact same way they ran out of their houses at 2:17. Gladys sees them, and for the first time in the whole movie, she's afraid. She runs. Out of the house, down the street, screaming. And seventeen children chase her down like a pack.

And they tear her apart.

Yes. The movie actually goes there. It's gory, it's shocking, and somehow the theater I was in started cheering. Because after everything she did, nobody was sorry.

13:10 - 14:25

THE ENDING - WHAT IT ALL MEANS

> *ON SCREEN: Morning light. Archer carrying Matthew down the street. Slow shots of the kids being returned home.*

With Gladys gone, the spell breaks. Archer snaps out of it, and the first thing he does is find Matthew. He picks up his son and carries him out of that house. And after a whole movie of him lying in that empty little bed, that moment hits like a truck.

The narrator tells us what happened next. The children came home. But not all of them came back the same. Some of them don't really talk anymore. Alex's parents never fully recover. And Alex goes to live with family who can actually protect him.

So why is it called Weapons? Think about it. Gladys turned people into weapons. Marcus. Paul. James. Archer. Even the kids. But the movie is also asking a bigger question. How fast did this town turn itself into a weapon? They blamed Justine with zero evidence. They looked right past a boy who was screaming for help in total silence. The witch was in the basement the whole time, and everyone was too busy pointing fingers to look down.

And Alex? The kid everyone ignored? He's the only one who actually saved anybody.

14:25 - 15:00

OUTRO + CALL TO ACTION

> *ON SCREEN: Slow zoom on the empty classroom clock as the hands land on 2:17. Fade to black. End screen.*

So, that's Weapons. A horror movie that's really about grief, blame, and the kids we fail to see.

Now I want to hear from you. Was Gladys the scariest horror villain of the year? Or does someone else take that crown? Fight it out in the comments.

If this recap pulled you in, subscribe and hit the bell, because the next one is even crazier, and it's right here on your screen. Go watch it.

And tonight, if you wake up and the clock says 2:17...

Don't open the door.

PRODUCTION NOTES (for editing, not narration)

• Pacing: read at about 152 words per minute. The narration is about 2,280 words, so it lands right at 15:00 with music beats and pauses.

• Pattern interrupts: change the shot every 4 to 7 seconds. Use a hard cut to black (half a second) before each big reveal line.

• Retention spikes: the basement reveal (about 6:05), the gas station chase (about 8:15) and the kids chasing Gladys (about 12:30). Put your strongest clips here.

• Engagement prompts (the boxes in this script) are placed at about 1:15, 3:40, 6:45 and 10:45, which is right before each new chapter, so viewers comment and keep watching.

• Music: low drone under Justine and Archer, silence for the basement reveal, a building score for the climax, and one soft piano line for Archer carrying Matthew.

• The '2:17' motif: show it on screen in the cold open, in Chapter 1, during the kids' chase, and on the final clock. That callback is what makes the ending land.

• Fair use: keep clips short, keep your voice over most footage, and add your own commentary on top of every clip.